

that has survived? I remember you all did the walnut challenge last time with the Honor 90. Have you all done something similar with this?

Madhav Sheth: We have done the Thar (SUV car) test. This time, I did the Thar test where we ran over the screen and it survived. I have shown this. So, a lot of people have trust issues that it probably isn't a real video or it's a gimmick. But I have never believed in any gimmicks and such. I have always tried to be as real as to the consumers. So, we did the test.

But to make sure that the people trust our X9B more, we have come up with three different plans. One is, if you do not like the phone within 90 days, no questions asked, you get 90 per cent of the refund back again. This is the first thing. So it's a buyback guarantee of 90 per cent of your refund in 30 days. So if you don't like the phone, take 90 per cent back and return the phone. That's point number one. Point number two, we are giving an extended warranty for another six months – so it is a standard of 12 months extended to another six months, which makes it a total of 18 months. Third thing, what we are giving is a one-time free screen replacement. Even if your screen breaks for whatever reason, you will get a screen replacement in the first six months for free.

So, I think we have gone to that extent to ensure that people get complete peace of mind and they trust the device more. It's not just about any marketing gimmick.

Digit: The HONOR X9B comes with 1920 Hz PWM dimming. Is it one of the highest PWM dimming rates at this price point?

Madhav Sheth: It is not one of the highest I would say, but it's one of the industry standards at this point. Maybe one or two devices would have around 2000 PWM dimming at this particular price point. But yes, the Honor 90 had the highest PWM dimming and

it is rated as one of the safest display phones in the industry. This also has the PWM dimming facility, but I think probably it's not one of the best in the price segment, I would say it is at par with the price segment.

Digit: Magic OS 7.2 will make its way onto the new X9B. Can you outline some of its best new features?

Madhav Sheth: See, AI has been over-abused, but Magic OS is one of the smoothest, bloatware-free operating systems right now. At the same point in time, it has a lot of AI capabilities which we will be showcasing during the launch. For instance, if you see the AI VLOG feature, there's an AI integration which automatically recognises the scenes and optimises the scenes accordingly. So, you don't need a content-creating team or an editing team. You can auto edit, you can auto type, you can auto get your captions done, lot of things can be automatically done over on the phone itself. So things are getting simplified. What is AI for? It's to make your life much more simpler and easier. That's something we should be focusing on rather than over, you know, over-abusing the word of AI. How can it help me in my day-to-day life?

Digit: The Honor X90 has one of the largest battery capacities in this price segment. So do you think this is more important for your target audience over maybe a more powerful processor and what prompted this decision?

Madhav Sheth: See, it's one thing. You have a smaller battery and keep a charger with you. It's a fast charger or a slow charger. Keep a charger with you. You have a bigger battery and you don't need to always carry one. What is more comfortable is now what the customer has to decide upon. But this Honor X9B is nothing different from the global variant but we are trying to first start bringing the technologies that Honor has globally. Honor X9B is one of the highest-selling phones

from the Honor portfolio which has sold more than 10 or 12 million units globally. So it's one of the most well-acknowledged phones by consumers outside of India and this is the reason I wanted to make sure to bring it to Indian audiences.

Q. So Honor is also entering the AIOT with the segment with a smartwatch and pair of earphones which I'm very excited about. Can you tell us a little bit about these two products?

Madhav Sheth: See AIOT ecosystem or the connected devices ecosystem is extremely important for consumers because it's a trust factor when they buy a device, they know that there is an interconnectivity to it. For a brand, it's a complementary product strategy. For us, it is like we are adding a product portfolio under our category by creating a hub out of it. When you connect a hub with a device, the most important aspect is the software. How do you communicate with each other? The software connectivity becomes one of the core factors rather than any of the hardware features on any of these devices.

Hardware features can be replicated, but what cannot be replicated by any of the brands is the software connectivity between the device and the TWS or the watch. Like say for example, with Honor AI Space you have an app in which you can customize your touch controls, even at this particular price point, you can customize your touch controls as per your comfort. At the same time for the watch, we pay membership for the color plates. But with this Honor Watch, there are workouts wherein you will get a free 100 hours of free credit workouts. without paying any charge. **d**

